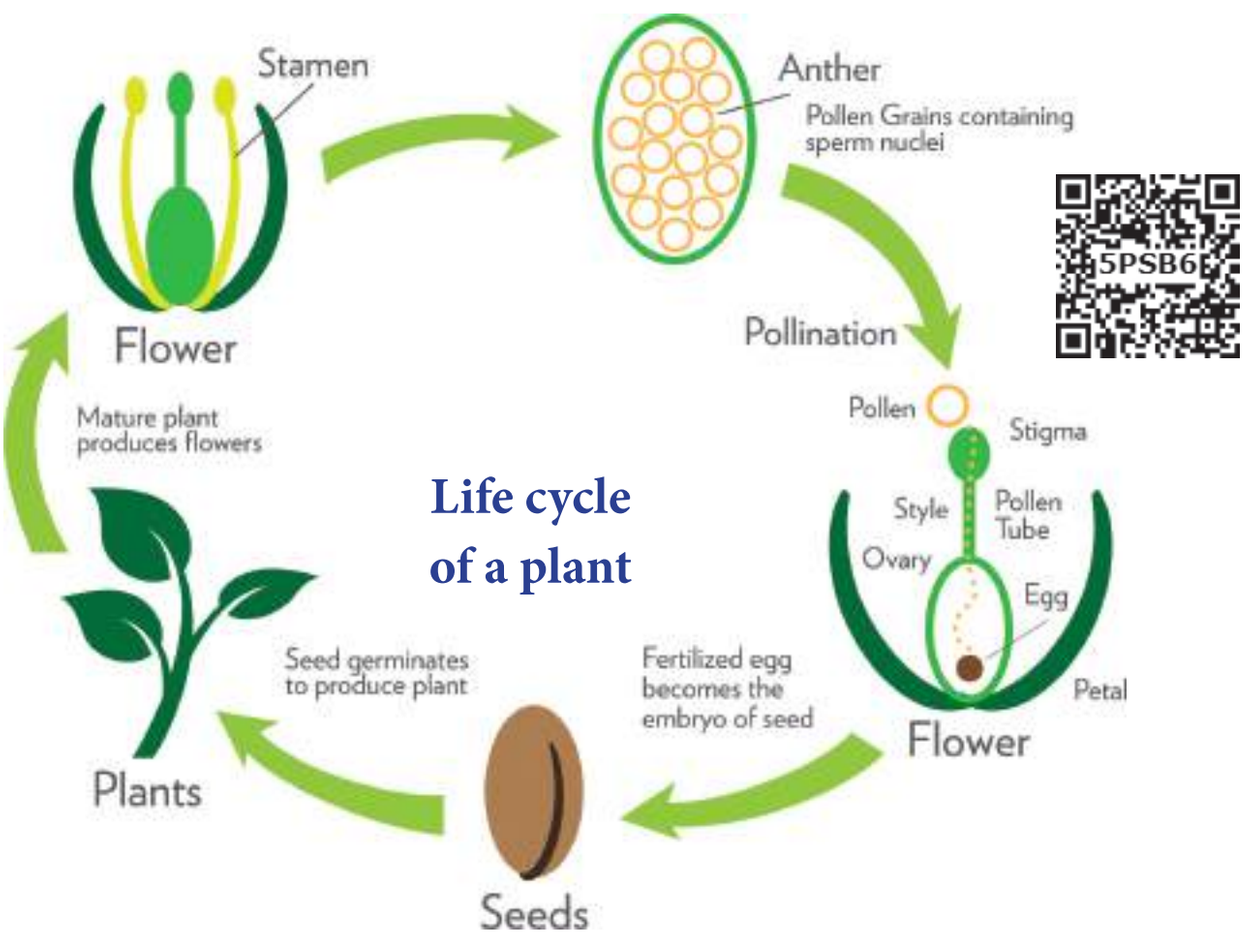
Beans (Fabaceae) and tomatoes (Solanaceae) commonly self-pollinate. Even though, for example, tomato self pollinate, they need the help of the insects to create vibrations within the flowers that will effectively loosen the pollen. Paddy is mostly self pollinating using just gentle wind as the pollinating agent. The agents that are helping in pollination are called **pollinators.**

In many plants, pollens have to come from some other flowers. This is obvious in case of plants which have distinct male and female flowers like pumpkin. In some flowers the gynoecium matures first before the androecium shed pollens. Such plants need cross pollination. Plants such as apples, plums, strawberries, pumpkins use insects for cross-pollination.

5.2.4 Fertilization

During pollination, pollen grains reach stigma. What happens to them after this? Substances produced on the stigma causes the pollen grain to germinate. During the germination a tube develops from the pollen grain which carries male gametes and ultimately reaches female gamete inside the ovary through the style. Male gamete fuses with the female gamete to form zygote. This process is known as **fertilization.**

Where is this female gamete located? Inside the ovary, small rounded structures, ovules are present. In these ovules, female gamete is present. To know more about this, we should cut ovary of a flower in longitudinal and transverse ways.



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